



TREE INSPECTION POLICY

Park Board Committee Meeting

Monday, May 4, 2026



Purpose



- This presentation is for the purpose of the Board to adopt the updated Tree Inspection Policy.
 - The presentation provides a summary of key changes under the new Tree Inspection Policy, rationale for the policy update and steps towards implementation.
 - The new policy establishes one comprehensive framework for all City and Park Board trees, and provides a consistent, practical, and safety-focused framework.



RECONCILIATION MISSION, VISION & VALUES

MISSION

Decolonize the Vancouver Park Board

The Park Board recognizes the institution's colonial history and upholds the Board's commitment to the 11 Reconciliation Strategies.

VISION

An evolvable organization in which every employee and Commissioner recognizes the humanity in themselves by recognizing and respecting the humanity of First Peoples; and an organization that sets a worldwide example in treating Reconciliation as a decolonization process.

VALUES

These values are your compass to help guide the way you work, interact with colleagues, external partners and the public.



PATIENCE

Colonialism didn't happen overnight. Untangling it takes time. We will pace ourselves for the marathon, not the sprint. We will adjust deadlines to ensure things are done well and respectfully.



CLARITY

We will focus on how colonialism functions to exclude, not on how to include.



PRAGMATISM

All staff are inheriting a system not of our making. The Park Board Reconciliation Team (PBRT) is here to assist colleagues with examining the ways colonialism continues to damage others. Blame is unproductive.



LEADERSHIP

We will nurture and sustain each other, demonstrating Indigenous principles in the way we function as a team.



LEARNING

We consent to learn in public. We will make mistakes. We will sit with those mistakes, be transparent about them, and use them both to learn and to teach. Our mistakes will be diagnostic tools.



The City and Park Board are responsible for >1-million trees



Trees are a core public asset



Public safety is a critical City obligation



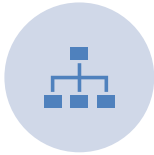
Environmental stewardship supports healthy cities



Public confidence in staff and leadership



Tree inspection methods follow best practices



A unified, Board and Council - approved framework is needed

- Park Board adopted the Urban Forest Strategy on May 12, 2025.
- The Urban Forest Strategy identifies five primary goals - updating the Tree Inspection Policy (1993) relates to Goal #1:
 - **Goal #1: Manage trees for health and safety;**
 - Goal #2: Protect the urban forest;
 - Goal #3: Engage residents in the urban forest;
 - Goal #4: Monitor the status and condition of the urban forest; and
 - Goal #5: Expand the urban forest
- To support the long-term operationalization of the policy, Urban Forestry will also develop an '*Urban Forest Management Standards*' document in 2027/2028

1993 Tree Inspection Policy Scope

A	Park Trees	Individual trees located within City parks and green spaces.
B	Street Trees	Individual trees growing along streets and boulevards as defined in the City's Street Tree By-Law No. 5985.
C	Forest Area Trees	Clusters of multiple trees growing together in wooded thickets or forested areas, rather than as single trees.

A



B



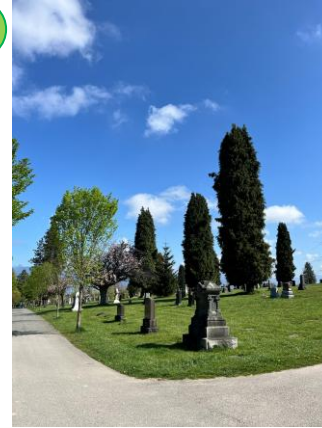
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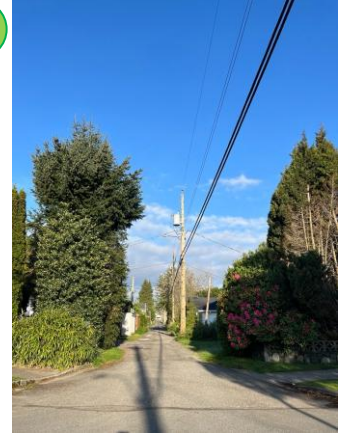
2026 Tree Inspection Policy Update – Additional Scope

D Civic Trees	Individual trees located on City-owned properties, such as civic buildings or facilities.
E Lane Trees	Individual trees growing in lanes that are easy for the public and City crews to access.
F Inaccessible Trees	Trees that are difficult for City staff or the public to access. This may occur when trees are behind fences, on occupied land, or blocked by surrounding properties.
G Shared Trees	Trees that grow straddling one or more property lines. These trees are shared between neighbouring properties, so responsibility is also shared.

D



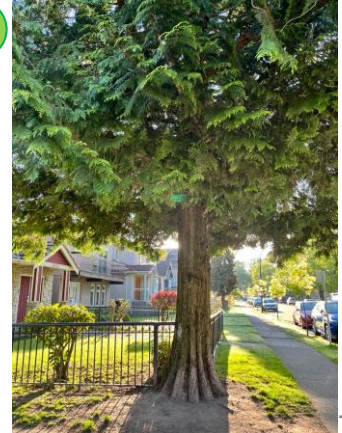
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F



G



- The new Tree Inspection Policy will replace the existing policy from 1993
- Establishes a consistent policy for all City and Park Board trees with one department (Urban Forestry) tasked to implement
- Defines:
 - Tree categories
 - Inspection frequencies and methods
 - Level 1: visual inspection, conducted from a particular vantage point
 - Level 2: a 360-degree ground-based inspection
 - Risk-based and time-sensitive response requirements
 - Aligns with recognized professional standards (ISA / TRAQ)

Comparison – 1993 vs 2026 Tree Inspection Policy

	Tree Inspection Policy (1993)	Tree Inspection Policy (2026)	Inspection level (2026)
Park Trees	✓	✓	Level 1 annually, Level 2 every 10-years
Street Trees	✓	✓	
Civic Trees	✗	✓	
Forest Area Trees	✓ *	✓	Level 1 every 3-years
Lane Trees	✗	✓	Reactive followed by Level 1 or 2 as needed
Inaccessible Trees	✗	✓	Reactive provided access / safety granted, followed by level 1 or level 2 as needed
Shared Trees	✗	✓	Depends on location (>50% City: as per tree category, <50%: reactive – level 1 or 2)

Response Times per Risk Rating

Extreme Risk – mitigate risks within 5 business days**

High Risk – mitigate risks within 90 days

Moderate Risk – re-inspect and/or mitigate risks within 1 year

Low Risk – within 10 years if necessary

* Only Forest Area Trees in Parks, not on other lands

**10 days for Shared Trees

- Reflects operational realities, including:
 - Access and terrain
 - Forest density
 - Staffing and equipment capacity
- Applies different approaches based on:
 - Location and use
 - Level of public interaction
 - Risk profile
- Focuses effort where impacts to public safety are highest



- A policy that balances risks with resources to guide safe, efficient tree maintenance
- Prioritizes proactive inspection in high-use areas
- Uses professional risk assessment to guide action (ISA TRAQ methodology)
- Establishes clear response timelines based on risk severity





Complete an inventory of outstanding tree and forest asset classes;



Upgrade UFO asset management software to allow task prioritization;



Update risk assessment process and response times;



Integrate blended services for enhanced service levels; and



January 1, 2027: Policy will be active starting in the new year.

THAT the Board receives this report and adopts the new Tree Inspection Policy as outlined in this report and attached as Appendix D

